

Westbrook University

Office of Academic Affairs

Policy No: ACAD-ATT-002

Effective: August 1, 2024

Revision: 1.0

Excused Absence Guidelines

1. Overview

This document defines the circumstances under which an absence from class will be considered excused by Westbrook University and outlines the process for requesting an excused absence.

2. Approved Categories of Excused Absence

The following circumstances constitute grounds for an excused absence:

2.1 Medical Illness

A student who is ill and unable to attend class must obtain documentation from a licensed healthcare provider. A doctor's note or clinic visit summary must be submitted to the instructor within 72 hours of the missed class.

- Note must include date of visit, treatment recommendation, and attestation that the student was seen
- Self-reported illness without documentation is not considered excused

2.2 Family Emergency

Absences due to the death of an immediate family member (parent, sibling, spouse, child, grandparent) or a serious medical emergency involving an immediate family member are excused. Students must notify the instructor as soon as possible and submit documentation (obituary, hospital admission record, etc.).

2.3 University-Sanctioned Activities

Participation in university-sanctioned activities — including athletic competitions, academic conferences, field trips, and performing arts events — constitutes an excused absence when the activity is officially listed in the university calendar and the student provides the instructor with advance written notice at least 5 business days before the absence.

2.4 Religious Observances

Absences for the observance of religious holidays are excused. Students must notify instructors in writing at least 14 calendar days before the anticipated absence. See Religious Holiday Absence Policy (ACAD-ATT-006).

2.5 Jury Duty and Legal Obligations

Students summoned for jury duty or required to appear in court must provide a copy of the court summons. The entire duration of jury service or court appearance is excused.

2.6 Military Duty

Students called to active military duty or training are excused for the full period of service. See Military Leave Policy (ACAD-WD-006).

3. Making Up Missed Work

Students with excused absences are entitled to make up missed examinations, quizzes, and assignments. It is the student's responsibility to contact the instructor within 48 hours of returning to campus to arrange make-up opportunities. Instructors must provide a reasonable opportunity to make up missed assessments within 5 business days.